

Apricot Flan

This isn't just dessert — it's the showstopper you make when you want the whole room to go quiet. Then smile. Then ask for seconds.

Components:

- Pastry
 - Filling
 - Topping
- (Yes, it's a three-parter. You're making edible art.)
-

Pastry

Light, buttery, with a whisper of almond — this crust holds everything together like the unsung hero it is.

- 1 cup plain flour
- 2 tablespoons sugar
- 2 tablespoons ground almonds
- 60g butter
- 2 egg yolks
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

Method:

1. Sift the flour into a bowl, stir in sugar and almonds.
2. Rub in the butter until it looks like dry breadcrumbs (and smells a little bit like heaven).
3. Mix in the egg yolks and vanilla to make a firm dough.
4. Turn it out, give it a light knead — just enough to bring it together without a fight.
5. Roll it to about 5mm thick, line a 23cm flan tin, and prick the base with a fork.
6. Pop it in the fridge for 30 minutes (the pastry needs a nap).
7. Line with greaseproof paper, fill with rice or beans, and bake at 180°C for 15 minutes.
8. Remove the weights and paper, and return to the oven for 10 minutes or until it's golden and proud.
9. Cool completely. (Yes, patience. You've come this far.)

Cooked once. Nailed it. Always repeated.

Filling

Think of this as the smooth-talking middle layer. Soft, creamy, and just rich enough.

- 3 egg yolks
- ½ cup sugar
- 2 tablespoons plain flour
- ¾ cup milk
- ½ cup cream

Method:

1. Lightly beat the egg yolks, flour, and sugar in a bowl — no need to go full meringue, just blend.
2. Gently heat the milk and stir it slowly into the egg mixture.
3. Pour it all into a saucepan and stir over low heat until thickened.
Do. Not. Boil.
4. Let it cool — it'll thicken more as it rests.
5. Whip the cream to soft peaks and gently fold it into the cooled custard.
6. Spoon it into your beautiful, baked shell. Don't worry if you pause to admire it. You should.

Topping

Apricots, glaze, and cream — this is the flourish that gets applause.

- 850g can apricot halves
- ½ cup apricot jam
- 1 tablespoon brandy
- ½ cup cream
- 30g flaked almonds, toasted

Method:

1. Drain the apricots and place them cut-side down over the custard. Be a little artistic if you feel like it.
2. In a small saucepan, melt the apricot jam with the brandy until smooth.
3. Brush this golden glaze over the apricots. This is your moment.
4. Chill the flan until set — it needs time to gather itself.

Cooked once. Nailed it. Always repeated.

A&J Food Collections

5. Toast the flaked almonds in the oven for 5 minutes at 180°C until golden. Cool them before sprinkling.
6. Whip the cream to soft peaks and pipe around the edges.
7. Sprinkle with almonds like edible confetti.



Serving Notes:

You can bake the shell a day ahead, but don't fill it until the day you serve — trust me, that crisp pastry deserves its crunch.

Cooked once. Nailed it. Always repeated.